KATHRYN E. SCHERTZ
Curriculum Vitae

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OSF | Google scholar | Research Gate | Personal website

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2026- **Assistant Professor of Psychology**
Iowa State University

2024-2026 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**
Michigan State University, Department of Psychology
Clinical Psychophysiology Lab

2022-2026 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**
University of Michigan, Department of Psychology
Emotion & Self Control Lab

EDUCATION

2022 **University of Chicago**
Ph.D., Psychology (Integrative Neuroscience concentration)
Certificate in Urban Science & Sustainable Development

2019 **University of Chicago**
M.A., Psychology

2008 **University of Pennsylvania**
B.A., Cognitive Science (Cognitive Neuroscience concentration)
Magna cum laude

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

2008–2014 Surface Warfare Officer, U.S. Navy
Norfolk, VA / Pearl Harbor, HI

GRANTS & AWARDS

2024 UROP Research Grant, University of Michigan ($1,000)
2018 Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation ($138,000)
2018 App Challenge First Place, University of Chicago ($7,000)

Submitted Grants

2026 *Distanced self-talk as a scalable, mechanistic intervention for the transdiagnostic treatment of anxiety and depression* (R33; MPIs: Schertz, Moser, Kross). National Institute of Mental Health. Score: Competitive, not discussed.

PUBLICATIONS

Patents

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., Berman, M.G., & Kompare, T.N. (2019). Routing in Navigation Applications based on Restorative Score. *U.S. Patent Accepted No. 16/418,522.* Washington, DC: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office.

Journal Articles and Chapters
* Indicates authors contributed equally

[30] Meidenbauer, K.L., Pourkhalili, S., **Schertz, K.E.,** Janey, E.A., Berman, M.G. (In press) Sensitive to what? Environmental sensitivity moderates affective associations with perceived safety, order, and social context. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*.

[29] Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kross, E., & Berman, M.G. (2026). Let's talk about nature: Understanding multifaceted nature experiences in the United States using social media. *Environment & Behavior, 58*(8), 1259-1287.

[28] Kardan, O., Sereeyothin, C., **Schertz, K.E.,** Angstadt, M., Weigard, A.S., Berman, M.G., Heitzeg, M.M., Rosenberg, M.D. (2026). Neighborhood air pollution is associated with attenuated neurocognitive maturation over early adolescence. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience,* 101719.

[27] Schertz, K.E.*, Orvell, A.*, Chandhok, S., Vickers, B.D., Moser, J.S., Ayduk, O., & Kross E. (2025). The frequency, form, and function of self-talk in everyday life. *Scientific Reports, 15*(1), 38883.

[26] Schertz, K.E.*, Meidenbauer, K.L.*, Freeman, T.R., Santiago, I.M., Janey, E.A., Gehrke, K., Samtani, A.L., Stier, A.J., & Berman, M.G. (2025). Identifying qualities and amenities associated with perceived cognitive restoration and improved affect in urban parks. *Journal of Environmental Psychology, 104,* 102624.

[25] Trinh, E.N.*, **Schertz, K.E.*,** & Kross, E. (2025). Do you have a minute? The cognitive & emotional consequences of self-disclosure at work. *Emotion*. Advance online publication: https://dx.doi.org/10.1037/emo0001539

Trinh, E.N. & Schertz, K.E. (August 20, 2025). Should you share personal stuff at work? Invited submission for "Character and Context" blog for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

[24] Rim, N.*, **Schertz, K.E.*,** & Berman, M.G. (2025). The affective, cognitive, and social benefits of interacting with nature. *Journal of Consumer Psychology, 35*(3), 495-510.

[23] Baldwin, C.R.*, **Schertz, K.E.*,** Orvell, A.*, Costello, C., Takahashi, S., Moser, J.S., Ayduk, O., & Kross, E. (2025). Managing emotions in everyday life: Why a toolbox of strategies matters. *Emotion*, *25*(5), 1122-1136.

> Baldwin, C.R., Orvell, A., & Schertz, K.E. (November 14, 2025). How Can I Deal With My Emotions In The Complexity Of Everyday Life? Invited submission for "Character and Context" blog for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

[22] Rodriguez, M., **Schertz, K.E.,** & Kross, E. (2025). How people think about being alone shapes their experience of loneliness. *Nature Communications , 16*(1), 1594.

[21] Meidenbauer, K.L., **Schertz, K.E.,** Janey, E.A., Stier, A.J., Samtani, A.L., Gehrke, K., Tucker, R., Hasan, M., & Berman, M.G. (2025) Evidence for environmental influences on impulsivity and aggression. *Urban Forestry & Urban Greening, 103,* 128594*.*

[20] Meidenbauer, K.L., **Schertz, K.E.,** Li, P., Sharma, A., Freeman, T.R., Janey, E.A., Stier, A.J., Samtani, A.L., Gehrke, K., & Berman, M.G. (2024). Variable and dynamic associations between hot weather, thermal comfort, and individuals' emotional states during summertime. *BMC Psychology, 12,* 504.

[19] Akcelik, G.N., Choe, K.W., Rosenberg, M.D., **Schertz, K.E.**, Meidenbauer, K.L., Zhang, T., Rim, N. Tucker, R., Talen, E., & Berman, M.G. (2024). Quantifying urban environments: Aesthetic preference through the lens of prospect-refuge theory. *Journal of Environmental Psychology, 97,* 102344.

[18] Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Schachner, J.N., Ip, K.I, **Schertz, K.E.,** Gonzalez, M.R., Abad, S., Herting, M.M. (2024). Building towards an adolescent neural urbanome: Expanding environmental measures using linked external data (LED) in the ABCD Study. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, *65*, 101338.

[17] Schertz, K.E., Kotabe, H.P., Meidenbauer, K.L., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Bowman, J.E., … & Berman, M.G. (2023). Nature's path to thinking about others and the surrounding environment. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, *89*, 102046.

> Schertz, K.E. (September 25, 2023). Thinking too much about yourself? Nature could help with that. Invited submission for "Character and Context" blog for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

[16] Schertz, K.E., Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., & Berman, M.G. (2022). Environmental influences on affect and cognition: A study of natural and commercial semi-public spaces. *Journal of Environmental Psychology, 83,* 101852*.*

[15] Kardan, O., Stier, A.J., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., **Schertz, K.E.**, Pruin, J.C., Deng, Y.,… & Rosenberg, M.D. (2022). Differences in the functional brain architecture of sustained attention and working memory in youth and adults. *PLoS Biology, 20*(12), e3001938.

[14] Akcelik, G.N., **Schertz, K.E.,** & Berman, M.G. (2022). The influence of low- and mid-level visual features on the perception of streetscape qualities. In B. Ionescu & W. Bainbridge, *Human perceptions of visual information: Psychological and computational perspectives*. Springer.

[13] Schertz, K.E., Saxon, J., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Bettencourt, L.M.A., Ding, Y., Hoffmann, H., & Berman, M.G. (2021). Neighborhood street activity and greenspace usage uniquely contribute to predicting crime. *npj Urban Sustainability, 1*, 19.

[12] Stier, A.J., **Schertz, K.E.**, Rim, N.W., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Lahey, B.B., Bettencourt, L.M.A., & Berman, M.G. (2021). Evidence and theory for lower rates of depression in larger US urban areas. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 118*(31), e2022472118.

[11] Berman, M.G., Stenfors, C.U.D., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Meidenbauer, K.L. (2021). Response to "Conceptual replication study and meta-analysis suggest simulated nature does not reliably restore pure executive attention measured by the Attention Network Task." *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 78, 101719.

[10] Schertz, K.E.*, Meidenbauer, K.L.*, & Berman, M.G. (2021). Understanding the affective benefits of interacting with nature. In E. Brymer, M. Rogerson, & J. Barton, *Nature and Health: Physical activity in nature*. Rutledge.

[9] Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2020). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*, *82*(8), 3945-3956.

[8] Meidenbauer, K.L., Stenfors, C.U.D., Bratman, G.N., Gross, J.J., **Schertz, K.E.**, Choe, K.W., & Berman, M.G. (2020). The affective benefits of nature exposure: What's nature got to do with it? *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 72, 101498.

[7] Layden, E.A., Li, H., **Schertz, K.E.**, Berman, M.G., & London, S.E. (2020). Experience selectively alters functional connectivity within a neural network to predict learned behavior in juvenile songbirds. *NeuroImage, 222,* 117218.

[6] Schertz, K.E. & Berman, M.G. (2019). Understanding nature and its cognitive benefits. *Current Directions in Psychological Science, 28*(5), 496-502.

[5] Stenfors, C.U.D., Van Hedger, S.C., **Schertz, K.E**., Meyer, F.A., Smith, K.E.L., Norman, G.J., … & Berman, M.G. (2019). Positive effects of nature on cognitive performance across multiple experiments: Test order but not affect modulates the cognitive effects. *Frontiers in Psychology*, *10*, 438004.

[4] Meidenbauer, K.L., Stenfors, C.U.D., Young, J., Layden, E.A., **Schertz, K.E.**, Kardan, O., Decety, J., Berman, M.G. (2019). The gradual development of the preference for natural environments. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, *65,* 101328.

[3] Layden, E.A., **Schertz, K.E.**, London, S.E., & Berman, M.G. (2019). Interhemispheric functional connectivity in the zebra finch brain, absent the corpus callosum in normal ontogeny. *NeuroImage*, *195*, 113-127.

[2] Van Hedger, K., Keedy, S.K., **Schertz, K.E.**, Berman, M.G., & de Wit, H. (2019). Effects of methamphetamine on neural responses to visual stimuli. *Psychopharmocology, 236*(6), 1741-1748.

[1] Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (2018). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. *Cognition, 174,* 82-93.

Manuscripts in Submission

[4] Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. Regulating Emotion from the Outside-In: Nature Experiences Reduce Rumination by Increasing Perspective Broadening (Under review, *Emotion*)

[3] Kardan, O., **Schertz, K.E.**, Martz, M.E., Paige, K.J., Heitzeg, M.M., Hicks., B.M., & Ilgen, M.A. Associations of access to alcohol and cannabis outlets, alcohol and cannabis use, and suicidal ideation. (Under review, *BMC Psychiatry*)

[2] Martz, M.E., McCurry, K.L., Soules, M., Jung, H.R., Litinas, K., Ekves, Z., Heitzeg, M.M., Russman Block, S.R., **Schertz, K.E.**, Taylor, S.F., & Peltier, S.J. Self-regulation of nucleus accumbens activation using real-time fMRI neurofeedback in adolescents and young adults. (Revise & Resubmit, *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*)

[1] Szaszi, B., Dunn, E., Folk, D., Clelland, H. T., Maier, M., Szecsi, P., … **Schertz, K.E.,** … Coles, N. A. (2026). A global megastudy of the effectiveness of popular activities for promoting happiness [Stage 1 Registered Report, under review]. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22788118

Manuscripts in Preparation

[3] Schertz, K.E., Hayden, A., Lin, Y., & Moser, J.S. Neurophysiological Effects of Mindfulness Training on Emotion Reactivity: Evidence from the Late Positive Potential.

[2] Orvell, A., **Schertz, K.E.**, Baldwin, C.R., Derosiers, K., Duckworth, A.L., Jonides, J., Katz, B., Willingham, D., & Kross, E. Teaching self-control promotes positive shifts in high school students' self-control knowledge, self-control behavior, and academic achievement.

[1] Janey, E.A., **Schertz, K.E.**, Meidenbauer, K.L., Van Hedger, S.C., & Berman, M.G. A Registered Replication to test the Restorative Effects of Viewing Nature Pictures on Working-Memory and Attention. (Stage 1 Registered Replication, Under Review, *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*)

Conference Proceedings

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2019). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 24(p. 124). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2018). ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 23(p. 284). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (2017). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 22(p. 101). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Chrysikou, E.G., **Schertz, K.**, & Thompson-Schill, S.L. (2007). Influencing the lingering garden path effect through tasks of executive control. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 12 (p. 129). Austin, TX: Psychonomic Society.

INVITED TALKS

McGill University, Social Psychology Seminar, Montreal, CA. (November 2026)

University of Wisconsin-Madison Social Psychology Proseminar, Madison, WI. (October 2026)

Center for Environmental Neuroscience Colloquium, Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin, DE. (March 2026)

Phipps Conservatory and Botanical Garden Biophilia Speaker Series, Pittsburgh, PA. (May 2024)

Wayne State University, Social Area Workshop, Detroit, MI. (April 2023)

College of Lake County Sustainability Council Earth Week, Chicago, IL. (April 2022)

University of Chicago-Tel Aviv University Workshop on Cities and Urbanism, Tel Aviv, Israel. (April 2019)

University of Chicago Wisdom Research Forum, Chicago, IL. (August 2017)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Schertz, K.E. (May 2026). What makes a city park restorative? Talk presented at the Association for Psychological Science Annual Conference, Barcelona, SP.

Schertz, K.E., Diamond, E., Rodriguez, M., Micale, S., Gordon, M.G., & Kross, E. (April 2026). Greener pastures: Natural public spaces promote positive engagement during conflict in

romantic relationships. Talk presented in the Presidential Invited Symposium at the Midwestern Psychological Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. (February 2026). How natural environments influence self-perspective to reduce rumination. Talk presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

Schertz, K.E., Diamond, E., Rodriguez, M., Micale, S., Gordon, M.G., & Kross, E. (November 2025). Grow together: The benefits of engaging with nature during conflict conversations in romantic relationships. Talk presented at the Society for Nature & Cognition Annual Conference, Denver, CO.

Schertz, K.E. & Jolink, T.A. (Co-chairs) (October 2025). From "meet cutes" to tough times: Experimentally testing signals of connection in close relationships. Symposium conducted at the Society for Experimental Social Psychology Annual Conference, Lisbon, PT.

Schertz, K.E., Diamond, E., Rodriguez, M., Gordon, M.G., & Kross, E. (October 2025). Talking it out in nature: How physical environments shape conflict conversations in romantic relationships. Talk presented at the Society for Experimental Social Psychology Annual Conference, Lisbon, PT.

Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. (February 2025). The use of natural environments for emotion regulation in everyday life. Poster presented at the Emotion pre-conference of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Conference, Denver, CO.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kross, E., & Berman, M.G. (October 2023). Examining multifaceted nature experiences using social media data. Talk presented at the Association for Psychological Science DIV 34 Annual Conference, Online.

Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. (June 2023). A tale of two paths to low effort emotion regulation. Talk presented at the International Organization of Psychophysiology, Geneva, CH.

Schertz, K.E. & Berman, M.G. (2022, June). Environmental influences on affect and cognition: A study of natural and commercial semi-public spaces. Talk presented at the Association for Psychological Science DIV 34 Annual Conference, Online.

Schertz, K.E., Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., Berman, M.G. (May 2022). Natural public spaces increase social and environmental thought content. Poster presented at the Association for Psychological Science Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.

Schertz, K.E., Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., Berman, M.G. (February 2022). Socially and environmentally focused thoughts are influenced by the surrounding physical environment. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (November 2019). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. Poster presented at the 60th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Montreal, QC.

Schertz, K.E., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Saxon, J., & Berman, M.G. (May 2019). Environmental and social engagement contribute uniquely to predicting crime. Poster presented at the 31st Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, Washington, D.C.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (November 2018). ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. Poster presented at the 59th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, New Orleans, LA.

Lyu, M., **Schertz, K.E.**, Choe, K.W., Chamberlain, B.C., Qin, X, Meitner, M.J., & Berman, M.G. (May 2018). Low-Level and semantic visual features predict preference in virtual environments. Poster presented at the 30th Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, San Francisco, CA.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (November 2017). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. Poster presented at the 58th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Vancouver, BC.

Schertz, K.E., Layden, E.A., London, S.E., & Berman, M.G. (November 2016). Functional connectivity and brain morphometry across development in zebra finches. Poster presented at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, CA.

Meyer, F., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Berman, M. G. (May 2016). Does interacting with nature in virtual reality restore directed attention? Poster presented at the 28th Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, Chicago, IL.

CAMPUS/DEPARTMENTAL TALKS

The psychological experience of nature (April 2026). Lunch & Learn for the Office of Sustainability Earth Day, University of Michigan.

Healthy places: How physical environments influence health and wellbeing. (November 2025). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

Research and Practice Panel (November 2024). Nature for Wellness Symposium, University of Michigan.

The power of place: Environmental impacts on social and cognitive outcomes. (October 2024). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

The psychological experience of nature: A Multi-Level, Multi-Method Analysis. (October 2023). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

This is your mind on nature. (September 2022). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

Environmental influences on thought content and connectedness. (November 2020). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

Environmental and Social Engagement Contribute Uniquely to Predicting Crime. (March 2019). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. (March 2018). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Behavioral Science & Public Policy (grad) – Teaching Assistant	Spring 2021
Big Data in the Psychological Sciences – Teaching Assistant	Winter 2021
Experimental Design I/II (grad) – Teaching Assistant	Spring & Fall 2020
Psychology and Neurobiology of Stress – Teaching Assistant	Fall 2019

Mentor for Thesis Students

Evan Renn (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2025
Sofia Micale (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2024
Ethan Driscoll (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2023
Senling Shu (Master's thesis, UChicago)	2022
Jillian Bowman (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UChicago)	2020
Tanvi Lakhtakia (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UChicago)	2020

SERVICE

Society for Nature and Cognition

2026-	Organizing Committee

University of Chicago Psychology Graduate Student Organization

2021-2022	Grad Cross Talks Workshop, Organizer
2018-2019 / 2020-2021	Mentorship Program Coordinator
2018-2021	Travel & Research Committee Head
2017-2022	Travel & Research Committee Member

Undergraduate Research Symposiums

2018	Chicago Area Symposium (Judge for posters)
2023, 2024	UMichigan Symposium (Judge for posters)
2024, 2026	UMichigan UROP Symposium (Judge for posters)

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

2026 Competitively selected participant, UC Davis/SDSU Event Related Potential (ERP) Bootcamp (10 day, in person workshop)

SKILLS

Languages: Expert in R. Familiar with SAS, Matlab, Python.
Data: Behavioral studies with adults (experimental and non-experimental); Neuroimaging (EEG); Qualtrics-based online surveys; U.S. Census data; cell phone mobility data; land cover data; Experience Sampling Methods; Physiological (ECG) signals
Analytics: Regression (e.g., Hierarchical/multilevel modeling, CCA), Frequentist and Bayesian approaches, Spatial/GIS Analysis, natural language processing (e.g., topic modeling)

PEER REVIEW ACTIVITIES

Ad-hoc reviewer for *PNAS, Science Advances, Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, Journal of Environmental Psychology, Environment & Behavior, Scientific Reports, Experimental Psychology, Parks Stewardship Forum, Psychological Reports, Ecopsychology, Frontiers in Psychology, International Journal of Wellbeing, Journal of Cognitive Psychology, Journal of Affective Disorders, Environmental Research, Royal Society Open Science*

ORGANIZATIONS

Society for Personality & Social Psychology
Association for Psychological Science
American Psychological Association
Society for Environmental, Population, & Conservation Psychology (APA Div 34)